Fights over resources

The long-running war witnessed by Goodall is the only sustained conflict among chimpanzees to have been fully documented, but violence within chimp communities has been recorded many times. Chimps have been observed stealing and killing baby chimps and rounding on a disliked alpha male. In communities studied in Uganda, males routinely beat the females they mate with. It is thought that this violent streak running through chimps may be associated with food resources and meat eating. When food is limited, the chimps become more violent in order to obtain the resources they need. Chimps are known to eat more meat when fruit is scarce.